

SOC EMAIL INVESTIGATION REPORT

Case Information

Case Number	EMAIL-2026052
Analyst	Graham McKean (aka CyberColumbo)
Date Opened	28 May 2026
Date Closed	02 June 2026
Alert Source	Email / Raw Message
Severity	Medium
Confidence	Medium
Classification	Likely Phishing

Executive Summary

A suspicious email titled "**Re: Collab for Your YT Channel dpuxb437**" was received by a MyDFIR mailbox and processed by SpamAssassin and subsequently reported to the SOC team for investigation.

The sender claimed to represent **Shure Media** and invited the recipient to participate in a creator partnership programme via an external dashboard link. The email originated from a Gmail account rather than an official Shure-owned domain and contained a call to action (CTA) URL hosted on **shor.by**.

Technical analysis identified suspicious indicators including the use of an external CTA link, social engineering themes, and a shortened/redirect style URL. However, no evidence was identified confirming credential harvesting, malware delivery, payment fraud, user compromise, or malicious destination behaviour.

Based on the available evidence, the email is classified as **Likely Phishing** with **Medium Confidence**.

Investigation Summary

The email was analysed using:

- Email authentication analysis
- Header review
- IOC extraction
- URL assessment
- Threat intelligence enrichment
- SpamAssassin telemetry
- MITRE ATT&CK mapping

Authentication checks showed that SPF and DKIM passed successfully, while DMARC was not present. Although the email was delivered via legitimate Google mail infrastructure, the sender identity could not be verified.

The primary attack vector identified was:

<https://shor.by/shure>

The destination URL was not dynamically analysed during this investigation; therefore no evidence exists to confirm credential harvesting, malware delivery, or other malicious behaviour.

Findings

Key Findings

Finding	Assessment
Sender used Gmail while claiming to represent Shure Media	Suspicious
External CTA link present	Suspicious
SPF Passed	Valid
DKIM Passed	Valid
DMARC Present	No
SpamAssassin KAM_SHORT Rule Triggered	Yes
URL Destination Analysed	No

User Click Activity Identified	No
Credentials Submitted	No Evidence
Malware Delivered	No Evidence
Additional Recipients Identified	None Identified

WHO

Sender

Display Name:
Shure Media

Email Address:
a01072207072@gmail.com

IP Address:
74.125.82.171

Recipient

inquiry@mydfir.com

Recipient Owner:
Steven Mah - MyDFIR Manager

WHAT

A partnership themed email was received that encouraged the recipient to access a creator dashboard through an external URL.

The email leveraged:

- Shure branding
- Sponsorship opportunities
- Creator partnership incentives
- External CTA links
- No attachments were present.

WHEN

Event	Timestamp
Email Sent	26 May 2026 20:23:39 +0300
Email Received	26 May 2026 13:23:54 -0400
Email Analysed	02 June 2026 14:42:28 UTC
Email Reported to SOC	User Reported; exact reporting time not available
Link Clicked	No Evidence
Credentials Submitted	No Evidence

WHERE

Delivery Channel

Email

Recipient Mailbox

inquiry@mydfir.com

Domains Observed

- gmail.com
- shor.by
- shure.com

URLs Observed

- <https://shor.by/shure>
 - <https://www.shure.com>
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WHY

The exact objective cannot be confirmed.

Based on the content and structure of the email, the sender appears to be attempting to persuade the recipient to interact with an externally hosted website using a partnership/sponsorship lure.

Potential objectives may include:

- Social engineering
- Information gathering
- User interaction with external infrastructure

The final objective could not be determined.

HOW

The sender used email-based social engineering by:

1. Claiming affiliation with Shure Media.
2. Offering creator partnership opportunities.
3. Providing an external dashboard link.
4. Encouraging recipient interaction through a call-to-action.

The email was delivered through legitimate Google mail infrastructure and successfully passed SPF and DKIM validation.

Technical Analysis

Email Authentication

Control	Result
SPF	Pass
DKIM	Valid
DMARC	Not Found
ARC	Present

DomainKey	False
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Header Analysis

Field	Value
From	Shure Media a01072207072@gmail.com
Reply-To	Unknown
Sender IP	74.125.82.171
Received Hop Count	3
Header Assessment	Suspicious

Assessment

Although authentication passed, the sender used a free Gmail account while claiming affiliation with a commercial organisation.

Email Content Analysis

Themes Observed

- Partnership / Sponsorship
- Financial Incentive
- Brand Association
- Trust Building

Not Observed

- Credential Requests
 - Password Resets
 - MFA Verification
 - Payment Requests
 - Attachments
-

IOC Analysis

Indicators of Compromise

Email Address

- a01072207072@gmail.com

Domains

- shor.by
- shure.com

IP Addresses

- 74.125.82.171

URLs

- <https://shor.by/shure>
 - <https://www.shure.com>
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URL Investigation

VirusTotal Analysis

URL:

<https://shor.by/shure>

Results:

- Detection Score: 0
- Community Score: 0
- Last Analysis Date: 20 May 2026 18:49:45 UTC
- Categories: Hosting, Information Technology, Filesharing, Downloads
- URL Status: Live (HTTP 200)
- Redirect Behaviour: Not observed by VirusTotal

Assessment

VirusTotal analysis identified no vendor detections, no community reports, and no known malicious reputation associated with the URL.

The URL remained accessible and returned a successful HTTP 200 response.

No evidence was identified confirming:

- Credential harvesting
- Malware delivery
- Payment fraud
- Known malicious infrastructure

Conclusion

The URL should be considered suspicious based on its use within a phishing themed email; however, external reputation analysis did not identify the URL as malicious.

URL behaviour analysis was not performed. External reputation analysis identified no malicious detections. The URL remains suspicious due to its context within the email but its functionality could not be conclusively determined.

Further behavioural analysis using a sandbox or browser isolation platform would be required to determine the exact functionality of the destination page.

Attachment Investigation

No attachments identified.

Attachment analysis was not required.

Threat Intelligence

Reputation Results

IOC	Source	Verdict
74.125.82.171	Local	Unknown
1e100.net	Local	Unknown
gmail.com	Local	Unknown
google.com	Local	Unknown
mail-dy1-f171.google.com	Local	Unknown

mail.gmail.com	Local	Unknown
mx.google.com	Local	Unknown
mydfir.com	Local	Unknown
shor.by	Local	Unknown
shure.com	Local	Unknown
srv7.swhc.ca	Local	Unknown
wiki.apache.org	Local	Unknown
www.shure.com	Local	Unknown
https://shor.by/shure	URLhaus	Not Available
https://www.shure.com	URLhaus	Not Available

Assessment

No positive threat intelligence hits were identified.

Important:

Unknown does not equal malicious.

No IOC was positively identified as malicious by available intelligence sources.

SpamAssassin Analysis

Rule	Description
DKIM_SIGNED	DKIM signature present
KAM_SHORT	Shortened/redirect-style URL detected
HTML_MESSAGE	HTML email detected

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Description
T1566	Phishing
T1566.002	Spearphishing Link
T1036	Masquerading (Possible)
T1027	Obfuscated Files or Information (Low Confidence)

Scope Investigation

Investigation Area	Result
Known Recipient	inquiry@mydfir.com
Additional Recipients Identified	None Identified
Similar Emails Found	None Identified
Related Campaign Identified	None Identified

Scope Investigation Summary:

Subject, sender, and related-theme searches were performed within Microsoft Defender Advanced Hunting over a 35-day period. No matching telemetry was identified. No evidence of additional recipients or related campaign activity was found within the monitored environment.

Scope Investigation Evidence

Objective

Determine whether the phishing email was observed within Microsoft Defender telemetry and whether additional recipients, related messages, or campaign activity existed in the monitored environment.

Tool Used

Microsoft Defender Advanced Hunting

Time Range

35 days

Query 1 – Subject Search

Purpose

Search for emails matching the known subject line or a key portion of the subject.

Query

EmailEvents
| where Subject contains "Collab for Your YT Channel"
| project Timestamp, SenderFromAddress, RecipientEmailAddress, Subject, DeliveryAction, DeliveryLocation
| order by Timestamp desc

Result

No results returned.

Assessment

No matching email events were identified using the subject-based search within the selected 35-day period.

Query 2 – Sender Address Search

Purpose

Search for any email activity from the known sender address, regardless of subject.

Query

EmailEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where SenderFromAddress =~ "a01072207072@gmail.com"
 or SenderMailFromAddress =~ "a01072207072@gmail.com"
| project Timestamp, SenderFromAddress, SenderMailFromAddress, RecipientEmailAddress, Subject, DeliveryAction, DeliveryLocation, NetworkMessageId
| order by Timestamp desc

Result

No results returned.

Assessment

No email events were identified from the sender address within the selected 35-day period.

Query 3 – Related Campaign / Theme Search

Purpose

Search for similar emails that may share the same phishing theme, sender domain, or lure content.

Query

```
EmailEvents  
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)  
| where SenderFromDomain =~ "gmail.com"  
| where Subject has_any ("Collab","Creator","Partnership","Shure")  
| project Timestamp, SenderFromAddress, RecipientEmailAddress, Subject  
| order by Timestamp desc
```

Result

No results returned.

Assessment

No related campaign or theme-based email activity was identified in Microsoft Defender Advanced Hunting within the selected 35-day period.

Scope Investigation Summary

Microsoft Defender Advanced Hunting was queried using the known email subject, sender address, and related campaign keywords over a 35-day period.

No matching results were returned from any of the searches.

Scope Conclusion

No matching Microsoft Defender email telemetry was identified for this message.

No evidence was found within Defender indicating:

- Additional recipients
- Similar emails
- Related phishing campaign activity
- Additional emails from the sender

Known Affected Recipient

inquiry@mydfir.com

Additional Recipients Identified

None identified within Microsoft Defender telemetry.

Related Campaign Identified

None identified within Microsoft Defender telemetry.

Important Limitation

The absence of results in Defender does not prove the email was never delivered anywhere. It means no matching telemetry was identified within the Defender-monitored environment.

Possible explanations include:

- The email was sent to a mailbox outside the Microsoft 365 tenant.
- The mailbox was not monitored by Defender.
- The email was analysed as a standalone/raw email sample.
- The email did not traverse Microsoft 365 mail flow.
- Relevant telemetry was unavailable or outside retention.

User Activity Investigation

Activity	Result
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Email Opened	Yes (Confirmed by recipient)
Link Clicked	No evidence identified
Credentials Submitted	No evidence identified
Attachment Opened	N/A
Suspicious Sign-ins	No result
Mailbox Rules Created	No result
OAuth Abuse	No result

Exposure Assessment

No evidence of user compromise identified.

User Activity Investigation Evidence

Objective

Determine whether the recipient interacted with the email and whether user activity could be identified within Microsoft Defender telemetry.

Query 1 – URL Click Investigation

Query

UrlClickEvents

| where Timestamp > ago(30d)

| where Url contains "shor.by"

| project Timestamp, AccountUpn, Url, ActionType, Workload

| order by Timestamp desc

Result

No results returned.

Assessment

No URL click telemetry was identified for the phishing URL within Microsoft Defender.

Query 2 – Recipient Mailbox Investigation

Query

EmailEvents

| where Timestamp > ago(30d)

| where RecipientEmailAddress =~ "inquiry@mydfir.com"

| project Timestamp, SenderFromAddress, RecipientEmailAddress, Subject, DeliveryAction

| order by Timestamp desc

Result

No results returned.

Assessment

No email telemetry was identified for the recipient mailbox within Microsoft Defender.

User Activity Conclusion

No evidence of user interaction was identified through available Microsoft Defender telemetry.

No evidence was identified for:

- URL clicks
- Credential submission
- Email delivery telemetry
- Recipient mailbox activity

User Statement

The recipient confirmed that the email was opened and reviewed.

No technical telemetry was available within Microsoft Defender to independently validate email open activity.

No evidence was identified indicating:

- URL clicks
- Credential submission
- Account compromise

Investigation Limitations

The following limitations impacted the investigation:

- No Microsoft Defender email telemetry was identified.
- Recipient mailbox activity could not be validated.
- URL behavioural analysis was not performed.
- No click telemetry was available.
- No mailbox audit data was available.

As a result, the final classification is based on observed email indicators rather than confirmed malicious behaviour.

User Activity Assessment

Status: Partial Validation

The recipient confirmed the email was opened and reviewed. No evidence of URL clicks, credential submission, or account compromise was identified. Technical validation of mailbox activity was unavailable due to the absence of Microsoft Defender telemetry.

Confidence: Medium

Reason:

Multiple telemetry sources were queried and no matching activity was identified.

Containment Actions

The following actions are recommended and should be documented if completed:

- Preserve original email
- Preserve headers
- Preserve URLs
- Search for additional recipients

- Quarantine or remove message
- Block malicious indicators if validated
- Notify affected users

Status:

Not Documented

Recovery Actions

Not required at this time.

Reason:

No evidence of:

- Credential submission
- Malware execution
- Account compromise

If future evidence emerges:

- Reset credentials
 - Revoke active sessions
 - Review mailbox rules
 - Review OAuth permissions
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Recommendations

Immediate Priority

1. Analyse <https://shor.by/shure> using a sandbox environment.
2. Validate URL behaviour and destination.
3. Search the environment for similar emails.
4. Preserve all evidence.
5. Confirm no additional users interacted with the email.

Medium Priority

1. Review sender reputation.
2. Validate sender legitimacy.
3. Notify affected users if additional recipients are identified.
4. Review mail gateway filtering effectiveness.

Lowest Priority

1. Create detections for partnership-themed phishing campaigns.
 2. Enhance monitoring of external CTA links.
 3. Tune detections for URL shortening and redirect services.
 4. Map detections to ATT&CK techniques identified during the investigation.
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Analyst Validation Checklist

Validation Item	Status
Evidence Supports Conclusions	Yes
Facts Separated From Assumptions	Yes
Threat Intelligence Reviewed	Yes
IOCs Documented	Yes
Classification Justified	Yes
URL Reputation Analysed	Yes
URL Behaviour Analysed	No
User Activity Reviewed	Yes
Scope Investigation Completed	Yes
Remediation Verified	No

Final Verdict

Classification: Likely Phishing

Confidence: Medium

The classification is based primarily on social engineering indicators, sender legitimacy concerns, and contextual URL analysis rather than confirmed malicious activity.

Reasoning:

The email contains multiple phishing indicators, including sender identity concerns, social engineering themes, and an external CTA link. However, no evidence was identified confirming malicious URL behaviour, credential harvesting, malware delivery, payment fraud, or user compromise. Additional URL and environment analysis would be required before elevating the classification to Confirmed Phishing.